



Risk Mitigation Case Brief

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Case A: Microsoft

Microsoft is a large technology company. The case study on them revolves around how they mitigated breaches during the Covid-19 Pandemic as the workplace went from a physical office to a digital ecosystem. Some methods of mitigation Microsoft began to adopt were to utilize a Zero Trust architecture, Multi-Factor Authentication, and performing routine security audits. These methods were part of a proactive approach by Microsoft as they “significantly reduced the incidence of data breaches and unauthorized access to Microsoft's networks and systems” rather than responding to incidents that already occurred. If Microsoft were to instead adopt risk avoidance, their employees would not be able to work from home during the Covid-19 Pandemic as they would be barred from using any digital resources or technology.

Case B: Google

Google is a multinational technology company that primarily provides internet based services. The case study discusses how Google and its subsidiaries like Youtube became prime targets for cyberattacks as they grew in popularity. Some methods of mitigating these threats included bug bounties, internal security reviews, and public disclosure policies. These methods encompassed a proactive approach to threats as they “successfully identified and helped patch hundreds of critical vulnerabilities across a range of software, enhancing the security of the digital ecosystem.” If Google were to use risk avoidance instead, then users would not be able to use their services at all.

Case C: JP Morgan & Chase

JP Morgan and Chase is a global leader in banking and financial services. The case study focuses on their response to a massive data breach in 2014. To prevent further incidents like this, JPM&C upped their cybersecurity budget to \$600 million dollars a year, using the budget to expand their cybersecurity workforce and invested in advanced cybersecurity technologies. This was a reactive response as JPM&C “experienced a massive data breach in 2014, affecting millions of customers. This incident served as a wake-up call, leading to

a comprehensive overhaul of its cybersecurity posture.” If they had taken a proactive approach instead then the initial data breach would have not have happened.